

GDS Holdings

Revised up 2026 booking target to 1GW; strong outlook at least until 2028, as per management

- **Significant new order wins; booking estimate revised up for 2026:** GDS raised its FY26 booking target to 1GW, from prior guidance of 500MW, driven by demand from its three largest hyperscale customers (77% of 1H26 bookings from the top 3 customers), along with some new demand upside from engagement with emerging AI customers. In addition, GDS has secured 600MW of reservations YTD and expects to secure 1GW+ of new reservations, providing high visibility on order conversion over the next couple of years (100% exercise rate over the past 1-1.5 years). Management also noted that strong demand is being driven by an on-track domestic GPU ramp and healthy new orders for CPUs, and appeared positive on the future chip supply situation. Overall, given the stronger booking momentum and rising backlog (1H backlog reached 757MW and should increase further to 1GW+ by end of 2026; each MW can generate ~RMB2.2mn of EBITDA annually, as per management), GDS raised its 2026 capex guidance to RMB10bn, from RMB9bn.
- **Expects move-ins to more than double in 2027, with further growth in 2028:** Given strong booking momentum in 2026, GDS now expects 2027 move-ins to more than double versus 2026, with the more meaningful uptick weighted toward 2H27, and it anticipates another step-up in 2028, which should drive significant EBITDA growth in the next few years. On workload mix, management indicated that move-ins are currently split roughly 50/50 between CPU-based and GPU-based capacity, with the GPU proportion likely to be slightly higher in 2027 as domestic GPU supply catches up.
- **Monthly Service Revenue (MSR) expected to decline over next 18 months, though gross profit yield remains at 10–11%:** While Tier-1 and new-market pricing levels are stable, GDS reported a 6% YoY decline in MSR in 2Q26 and expects a ~3% YoY decline in 4Q26, with a similar magnitude of decline anticipated next year. Management expects the MSR downtrend to continue for another 18 months, driven by ongoing pricing adjustments on legacy contracts. Nevertheless, the company has revised up its 2026 revenue and EBITDA growth estimates to 12%+ and 11%+, from prior guidance of ~11% and ~9% YoY at the midpoint, primarily driven by volume growth on strong AI demand, and expects gross profit yield to remain within the 10-11% range.
- **Higher power % in revenue weighs on EBITDA margin as MSR softens:** GDS reported a 2Q26 EBITDA margin of 45.5%, down 1.8ppts YoY and 3.2ppts QoQ. This reflects the mechanics of its revenue mix: power costs are passed through to customers at no margin but are still booked within the revenue line. As a result, a lower MSR raises power's share of total revenue, mechanically compressing the EBITDA margin.

Not Rated

GDS, GDS US
Price (14 Aug 26):\$34.41

Technology and Telecoms

Gokul Hariharan ^{AC}

(852) 2800-8564
gokul.hariharan@jpmorgan.com
J.P. Morgan Securities (Asia Pacific) Limited/ J.P. Morgan Broking (Hong Kong) Limited

Jennifer Hsieh

(886-2) 2725-9868
jennifer.hsieh@jpmorgan.com
J.P. Morgan Securities (Taiwan) Limited

David Chou

(886-2) 2725-9618
david.chou@jpmorgan.com
J.P. Morgan Securities (Taiwan) Limited

Jason Chen

(886-2) 2725-9864
jason.bh.chen@jpmorgan.com
J.P. Morgan Securities (Taiwan) Limited

Subham Singhania

(91-22) 6157-3801
subham.singhania@jpmorgan.com
J.P. Morgan India Private Limited

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GDS Holdings (GDS, GDS US) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
28-Mar-24	N	6.33	7
23-May-24	N	8.01	7.5
20-Mar-25	N	30.61	34
16-Jul-25	OW	37.72	46
21-Nov-25	OW	30.29	40
03-Feb-26	OW	45.08	55
16-Mar-26	NR	42.86	--

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Dec 05, 2016. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

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